

OFRI FREIBACH

ENERGY ECONOMIST | RENEWABLE ENERGY, STORAGE & TECHNO-ECONOMIC MODELING

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Energy economist with four years of experience leading techno-economic modeling and advising government and private-sector clients on renewable energy, battery storage, and climate policy. Experienced in investment appraisal, regulatory and market analysis, storage optimization, econometrics, and translating complex quantitative analysis into decision-ready recommendations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Energy Economics Consultant | Self-employed

Feb 2026–Present

- Provide economic research and modeling services in renewable energy, energy storage, greenhouse-gas life-cycle analysis, and emissions-reduction strategies.
- Mentor participants in the Yannay Institute for Energy Security internship program.

Senior Economist | EcoTraders

2022–2025

- Led the development of a flexible techno-economic model assessing the financial viability and required government support for different PV and battery storage configurations, while optimizing battery capacity based on tariffs, regulation, generation profiles, and project economics.
- Managed Israel's national greenhouse-gas emissions projection model for two consecutive years, generating projections used in official national reports submitted to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change and presented at the annual Conference of the Parties.
- Presented conclusions through reports, executive presentations, and dashboards; managed one direct report.

Economist (Student) | Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development

2020–2022

- Conducted market research and economic analysis, assessing policy effects on domestic industries, competition, prices, and market conditions.
- Translated quantitative findings into policy recommendations for senior decision-makers and led the ministry's 2022 report on Israel's wine industry.

EDUCATION

MA in Economics | The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2022–2025

Thesis (Grade 95): "From Financial Incentives to Installation: The Economics of Solar Adoption in Israel"

- Examined how system costs and feed-in tariff levels and structures affect the diffusion of photovoltaic systems in Israel.
- Built an 18-million-observation panel dataset covering approximately 1.3 million rooftops and 50,000 PV adopters; applied probit and discrete-time hazard models to estimate how tariffs and expected project returns affect PV deployment.

BSc in Environmental Economics and Management, with distinction

2019–2022

ANALYTICAL & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Energy economics and financial modeling: Techno-economic modeling, PV and storage optimization modeling, cost-benefit analysis, regulatory analysis.

Quantitative methods: Econometrics, statistical analysis, large-scale panel data, market research, data visualization

Tools: Excel – advanced (Power Query and macros); R – advanced; Python – intermediate

Languages: Hebrew – native; English – fluent

MILITARY SERVICE

Captain | Israeli Air Defense Forces

2012–2017

- Served as deputy commander of a 120-person Iron Dome battery, supporting operational management, personnel leadership, training, and mission readiness.
- Managed international cooperation courses in air force battle management, coordinating professional content, logistics, participants, and operational stakeholders; previously served as a procedures and doctrine officer.

MAIN PUBLICATIONS

- Geographic-Energetic-Economic Model for the Advancement of Renewable Energy — Ecology and Environment, 2024 | Lead author
- Energy Security and Public Health in Gush Dan: A Renewable Energy and Storage-Based Solution — Ministry of Energy, 2023 | Lead author
- Israel's Greenhouse Gas Emissions Reduction Report — Ministry of Environmental Protection, 2023–2024 | Lead author